Minutes of the
General Government Committee Meeting
Held in the Council Chambers, Ajax Town Hall and Electronically
At 1:00 p.m. on October 15, 2024

Alternative formats available upon request by contacting:
accessibility@ajax.ca or 905-619-2529 ext. 3347

Present:	Chair – Councillor	S. Lee
	Regional Councillors	M. Crawford
		J. Dies
	Councillors	N. Henry
		L. Bower
	Mayor	S. Collier
Regrets:	Councillor	R. Tyler Morin

1. Call to Order & Acknowledgement of Traditional Treaty Lands

Chair Lee called the meeting to order at 1:00 p.m. and acknowledged traditional treaty lands.

2. Disclosure of Pecuniary Interest

There were no disclosures of pecuniary interest.

3. Adoption of Minutes

3.1 Regular Meeting

Moved by: L. Bower

That the Minutes of the regular meeting of the General Government Committee held September 9, 2024, be adopted.

CARRIED

4. Consent Agenda

Members separated items 4.1, 4.2, 4.3, 4.4, 4.6, 4.7, 4.8, 4.10 and 4.11 for discussion.

With the consent of Members present, items 4.6, 4.7 and 4.8 were advanced in the order business.

4.6 **OES-2024-24: Contract Award – Town Hall – Accommodation Strategy – Phase 1**

Committee Members asked questions related to the contents of the report. Dave Meredith, Director of Operations & Environmental Services and Nicole Cooper, Deputy Chief Administrative Officer, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: S. Collier

1. That Council award the Contract for Town Hall Renovation – Accommodation Phase 1, to BCL Constructors Ltd. in the amount of $492,278.85 (inclusive of all taxes).

2. That council approve funding of $479,883.57 to be allocated to Capital Account No. 1039011 from the Building Maintenance Reserve Fund.

CARRIED

4.7 **PDS-2024-22: Updated Planning Application Review Process and Planning Act Fees to Address Bill 185 (Cutting Red Tape to Build More Homes Act, 2024)**

Committee Members asked questions related to the contents of the report. Stev Andis, Manager of Planning, Peter Simcisko, Managing Partner, Watson & Associates Economists Ltd., Geoff Romanowski, Director of Planning & Development Services, and Jaclyn Grossi, Municipal Clerk, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: S. Collier

1. That the report entitled “Updated Planning Application Review Process and Planning Act Fees to Address Bill 185 (*Cutting Red Tape to Build More Homes Act, 2024*)” be received for information;

2. That Pre-consultation By-law 82-2022 be repealed and the proposed new Pre-consultation By-law, included as ATT-1 to this report, be approved;

3. That the amending By-law to the Town of Ajax Fees and Charges By-law No. 56-2023 for the 2024 Planning Act fees, included as ATT-2 to this report, be approved and come into effect on October 22, 2024; and

4. That the amending By-law to the Town of Ajax Fees and Charges By-law No. 61-2024 for the 2025 Planning Act fees, included as ATT-3 to this report, be approved and come into effect on January 1, 2025.

CARRIED

4.8 **PDS-2024-23: Financial Obligations for the Audley Road and Chambers Drive Extensions**

Committee Members asked questions related to the contents of the report. Dianne Valentim, Director of Finance/Treasurer, Julie Mepham, Manager of Budgets & Accounting, and G. Romanowski, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: L. Bower

1. That the Town enter into minutes of settlement with 537 Kingston Road East (Ajax) Holdings ULC (hereinafter referred to as the "owner") pertaining to the owner's financial obligations for the Audley Road and Chambers Drive extensions, as provided in Attachment 1 to this report;

2. That the Town be authorized to prepare and enter into a Construction Administration Agreement with the owner for the interim Audley Road extension (as hereinafter defined), substantially in the form as provided in Attachment 2 to this report; and

3. That Council approve the following funding, to be allocated to unbudgeted Capital Account No. 24090314 from the following reserve/reserve funds:

Developer Contribution (to be collected/credited through Site Plan)	$1,601,100
Development Charges – 2018	$912,700
Development Reserve	$48,000
Total	$2,561,800

CARRIED

4.1 **PSA-2024-07: Municipal Accommodation Tax**

Committee Members asked questions related to the contents of the report. Robert Humphrey, Business Retention & Expansion Advisor, Kassandra Cruciano, Manager of Strategic Initiatives, and N. Cooper, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: M. Crawford

1. That Report PSA-2024-07 be received for information;

2. That staff be directed to bring forward a Municipal Accommodation Tax (MAT) By-law, establishing a MAT rate of 5%, effective January 1, 2025, with terms in alignment with the considerations of this report before the end of 2024;

3. That the CAO be granted the delegated authority to enter into an agreement with an Eligible Tourism Entity for the exclusive purpose of promoting tourism in Ajax; and

4. That a reserve for the portion of the Municipal Accommodation Tax revenue that is retained by the Town be established.

CARRIED

4.2 **PSA-2024-08: Review of Traditional Communications Tools**

Committee Members asked questions related to the contents of the report. Christie McLardie, Director of Public & Strategic Affairs and Devon Jarvis, Supervisor of Communications & Engagement, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: M. Crawford

That this report be received for information.

CARRIED

4.3 **PSA-2024-09: Green and Inclusive Community Buildings Program**

Committee Members asked questions related to the contents of the report. D. Meredith, Liam Nichols, Grants & Strategic Initiatives Coordinator, and C. McLardie, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: J. Dies

That Council endorse the project ACC Rec Master Plan Renovation for submission under the Green and Inclusive Community Buildings Program for funding towards the construction and implementation of the project.

CARRIED

4.4 **AFES-2024-03: Specialized Fire Rescue Response Agreement with Oshawa Fire Service**

Committee Members asked questions related to the contents of the report. Aaron Burridge, Fire Chief, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: N. Henry

1. That the recommended specialized rescue agreement (ATT-1) be approved.

CARRIED

4.5 **APL-2024-02: 2023 Library Reserve Balances**

Moved by: S. Collier

1. That this report be received for information.

CARRIED

4.9 **PDS-2024-24: Repealing By-law – Repeal of By-law Number 52-2020**

Moved by: S. Collier

That the proposed by-law to repeal By-law Number 52-2020, as provided in Attachment 1 to this report, be passed by Council at its meeting on October 21, 2024.

CARRIED

4.10 **RC-2024-06: Ajax Markets Update**

Committee Members asked questions related to the contents of the report. Chris Vida, Director of Recreation & Culture, Robert Gruber, Manager of Culture & Events, and K. Cruciano, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: N. Henry

That report RC-2024-06 “Ajax Markets Update” be received for information.

CARRIED

4.11 **CS-2024-15: Integrity Commissioner Appointment**

Committee Members had no questions for staff.

Moved by: N. Henry

That a by-law to appoint SC Consulting (Suzanne Craig) as Integrity Commissioner for the Town of Ajax be presented to Council for approval.

CARRIED

5. Discussion

None

6. Presentations

6.1 **AFES-2024-02: Updates to the Fire Department Establishing and Regulating By-law**

Shain Kimbell, Deputy Fire Chief, delivered a presentation related to updates to the Fire Department Establishing and Regulating By-law.

Committee Members asked questions related to the presentation. S. Kimbell and A. Burridge, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: L. Bower

1. That the report on Updates to the Fire Department Establishing and Regulating By-law be received for information.

2. That the updated Fire Department Establishing and Regulating By-law, included as ATT-1 to this report be approved.

CARRIED

7. Closed Session

None

8. Adjournment (3:03 p.m.)

Moved by: M. Crawford

That the October 15, 2024 meeting of the General Government Committee be adjourned.

CARRIED